

whatsUp!

Waterberg News, Happenings and Events July 2018

'I dream of our vast deserts, of our forests, of our great wildernesses. We must never forget that it is our duty to protect this environment.' Nelson Mandela

A great Initiative from Lapalala Wilderness School

Lapalala Wilderness School, other local organisations, children from 79 schools and Bakenberg Local communities had a wonderful day of celebration of World Environment Day in the Bakenberg Stadium. Initiated in 1972 by the United Nations General Assembly and United Nations Environment Programme to encourage awareness and protection of the natural environment, the day aims to raise awareness of emerging environmental issues from marine pollution, human over population, global warming, sustainable consumption, land pollution and environmental crimes. Our theme was beating Plastic Pollution in our local river system, which was preceded by four days of an intensive clean –up campaign in the local Bakenberg areas.
Lapalala Wilderness School.



Rare Sighting 1 - Boomslang vs Chameleon.

WNC exco member **Marelize Pieterse** walked outside her house to find this battle between a junior seemingly inexperienced boomslang struggling with a chameleon, even hanging it from a tree (which didn't work) before eventually swallowing its winter meal.

Rare Sighting 2 - Drongo vs Bronze Mannikin

Another rare sighting in the unusual surroundings of the Modi Mall parking lot. WNC member **Hendrik Viljoen** spotted a fork tailed drongo with a bronze mannikin in its beak. It flew 30 m to a tree, decapitated its prey and fed on it until it dropped to the ground.



The Welgevonden 'Team' Runs On!

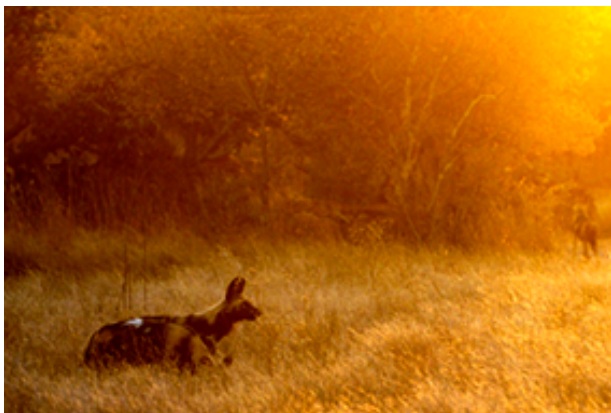
Sam Davidson Phillips, Pip Myram and Brad Schroeder, in that order, finished the 90km Comrades marathon within the 12 hour cut-off time, brilliantly done guys - must be something in the Waterberg air. Pip sneezed just as she crossed the line causing Brad to break-up with laughter! Where did they find the energy?

Speaking of Welgevonden, welcome back to **Shaun McCartney** who replaces **Brad Schroder** as CEO. We wish Brad good luck in his PHD and thank him for his support of the WNC. Shaun clearly finds the Waterberg more interesting than brewing craft beer in Mpumalanga!

The **WNC Creche Teacher Training Project** is progressing well with some of the creche teachers even attending the training classes during school holidays. Well done Suzette Van Dyk, keeping the interest high.

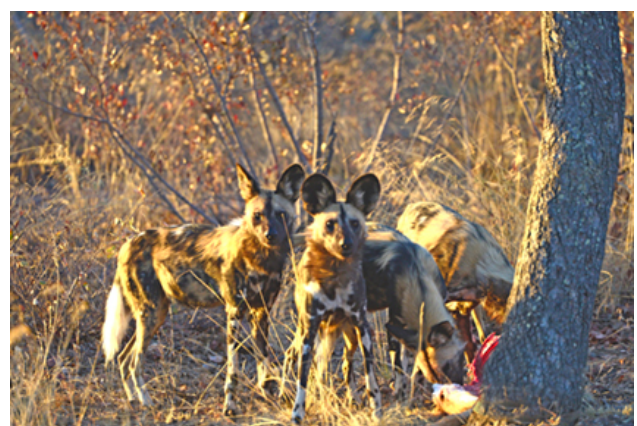
****The creches are still in desperate need of educational materials for pre-school age children****

If you have any suitable materials contact WNC secretary Sue Walker on 082 934 2626 or the school on 078 685 3127.



The Waterberg Wild Dog Pack continue to make headlines with the EWT initiative of conducting visits to raise funds to protect the dogs proving very successful. The dogs have denned and it appears the alpha female has pupped and we await the pups appearance with bated breath. We would encourage everyone to take advantage of this opportunity to see South Africa's last free roaming pack of this highly endangered species. Contact EWT's Derek Van Der Merwe at derek@ewt.org.za and 083 447 9335 to arrange a visit.

Images Robin Taylor.



General Meeting June 28th

There was an outstanding turnout for the June meeting with more than 60 members and guests gathered to hear our, as always, interesting speakers on a variety of relevant subjects, and of course to socialise afterwards.

Marie-Tinka Uys of Kruger to Canyon (K2C) Biosphere gave us a detailed insight into both the formation, workings and how a biosphere can be run. K2C is possibly the most successful biosphere in the country and Marie-Tinka's presentation showed exactly the importance of the organisation and how it can and should benefit the community as a whole. Some really useful information and background for our own very new Biosphere committee.

Local game breeder, hunter and entrepreneur **Ant Baber** spoke on the ups and downs of breeding game species. It became apparent from his presentation that like any business, game breeding attracts many people who are there for the quick profit - they jump in when they see prices rising, but that's usually too late and they get hurt when naturally, due to the many breeders involved, prices drop - but as Ant pointed out, if you're in for the long haul, prices will rise again when all the 'chancers' drop out. Very thought provoking.

Judi Groenewald of **Agri Tourism South Africa** opened our eyes with a dynamic presentation which I'm quite sure was of great interest to our local farmers - Agri Tourism, an alternative and added source of income which has already proven very successful around the country. Judi showed us all the ups (I don't see any downs) of this really exciting addition to any farmer's income stream and an entree into the world's second largest industry - Tourism. For more info <www.agritourismsouthafrica.com> judi@agritourismsouthafrica.com - 083 285 2979.

Nick Heal's famed Caldo Verde soup and drinks was the perfect way to cap a successful meeting with much discussion on the subjects raised by the speakers.

We would like to welcome new members

Chris and Carol Van Der Merwe
Susie Airy

The Market Place



Set in secluded hilly woodland on a private game reserve, this stone & thatch cottage offers tranquillity, privacy and luxurious self-catering accommodation for four with its own pool and braai lapa, scenic walks and mountain bike trails, only 220 kms from Pretoria. Contact Richard or Lyn on 083 609 1464/ 083 609 1425 <yeldaw@mweb.co.za> www.mokabilodge.com



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Dates to Diarise

The WNC Family Day Picnic takes place on September 29th with live music, food stalls, braai, auction and so much more at Matamba Bush Campsite. Watch out for more detail!

Next general meeting 2pm Thursday 30 August at NG Kerk

With great speakers on important matters for all Waterbergers

We are always looking for material for whatsUp! If you have any articles of interest, local news, pictures, stories or events, please submit them to the editor



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